potassium content, it helps in cleansing the kidneys and flushing out kidney stones.

- **Radish** - Radish can be soaked in water overnight. The water if strained and drunk twice a day is a popular remedy for kidney stones.
- **Figs** - Boiling two figs in a cup of water and drinking it on an empty stomach every morning could be helpful in dissolving kidney stones.
- **Loose weight** - A healthy weight combined with a healthy diet rich in nutritious, fibre filled fruits is considered essential to the prevention of kidney stones and for their treatment.

10.4.7. Prevention

People with a history of stone formation can probably diminish their chances of stone formation by the following measures:

- Adequate fluid intake, ensuring over 2 litres of urine daily.
- Treat urinary infection promptly. Decrease dietary calcium. Restrict intake to less than 600 mg by decreasing intake of milk products.
- Reduce calcium absorption.
- Restrict protein intake.

SUMMARY

- ❖ Kidneys remove waste products of nitrogen metabolism. Urea, uric acid and creatinine are excreted.
- ❖ Glomerulonephritis is an inflammatory process affecting the glomeruli, the small blood vessels in the head of the nephron.
- ❖ The main cause of glomerulonephritis is streptococcal infection.
- ❖ The symptoms of nephritis are haematuria, proteinuria, oedema, shortness of breath, tachycardia, elevated blood pressure, anorexia, oliguria or anuria and uraemia.
- ❖ High calorie, low protein with restricted fluid, sodium, potassium and phosphorus diet is given for a patient suffering from glomerulonephritis.
- ❖ Urolithiasis or renal calculi can be found lodged in the urinary tract namely, kidney, ureters, bladder or urethra.
- ❖ The essential phase in stone formation is condensation of specific molecules within the collecting system. These molecules of mucopolysaccharides and mucoproteins form a matrix united by a strong chemical bond, with deposition of crystals in them as a secondary phenomenon.
- ❖ The main causes of kidney stones are hot climate, heredity, low fluid intake and repeated urinary tract infection. Excessive urinary excretion of calcium predisposes to formation of calcium stones.
- ❖ The most common constituents of kidney stones are oxalates, urates or phosphates, combined with calcium.
- ❖ The fundamental principle in the treatment of kidney stones is to supply adequate fluids like water, coconut water, barley water, fruit juices and weak tea in order to ensure the passage of over 2000ml of urine per day.
- ❖ Depending on the type of stones, the foods rich in that particular constituent is avoided.

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